INCH-POUND

A-A-52117
September 25, 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TONGS, FOOD SERVING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to MIL-T-40097.

1. ABSTRACT

1.1 Abstract. This commercial item description covers the following three sizes of food serving tongs:

Size 1 - 6 ± 1/4 inches long
Size 2 - 9 ± 3/8 inches long
Size 3 - 12 ± 1/2 inches long

2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

2.1 Design and construction. The food serving tongs shall be constructed from 300 or 400 series stainless steel, sheet or strip. They shall be free of seams or cracks and contain no sharp edges, slivers, or burrs that may cause injury. The jaws of the tongs shall have a saw tooth configuration. The action of the food serving tongs shall be such that the open end shall spring open to the original dimensions (minimum) after 25 cycles of compression and shall remain in the open position. The food serving tongs shall have the following stainless steel gauges, handle widths, and jaw openings.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any other data which may improve this document should be sent by letter to: Commander, U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, ATTN: SATNC-WEE, Natick, MA 01760-5018.

AMSC N/A FSC 7330

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Size	Stainless Steel Gauge (Minimum)	Width of Tong Jaws (Minimum)	Tong Jaw Opening* (minimum)
1	.0250 inch (24 GA)	3/4 ± 1/16 inch	2-3/8-inches
2	.0312 inch (22 GA)	15/16 ± 1/16 inch	3-1/4-inches
3	.0375 inch (20 GA)	1-1/8 ± 1/16 inch	3-inches

*Measured between the tips of the saw teeth.

2.2 Codes and standards. The food serving tongs shall comply with National Sanitation Foundation (NSF) Criteria C-2, Special Equipment and/or Devices.

2.3 Identification marking ("Government unique" requirement). The food serving tongs shall be permanently and legibly marked with the manufacturer's identification marking. Use of "stick-on" or removable labels is prohibited.

3. QUALITY ASSURANCE

3.1 Certification. The contractor shall certify, and maintain substantiating evidence, that the product offered meets the salient characteristics and requirements of this commercial item description, that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

3.2 Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, provided they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376 and all other requirements of this commercial item description are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

3.3 Regulatory requirements. In accordance with section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Government's policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practical, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing supplier's employees

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to undue hazards from the recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable. The term "recovered materials" means materials which have been collected or removed from solid waste and reprocessed to become a source of raw materials as opposed to virgin raw materials. None of the above shall be interpreted to mean that the use of used or rebuilt products are allowed under this commercial item description unless otherwise specified.

3.4 National Sanitation Foundation (NSF). Acceptable evidence of meeting the requirements of NSF shall be one of the following:

(1) A listing in the current edition of the NSF "Listing of Food Service Equipment" and display of the NSF seal on the serving tongs or

(2) A certification of the serving tongs issued by NSF under their special one-time contract evaluation/certification service or

(3) A certified test report from a recognized independent testing laboratory acceptable to the Government agency for which food serving tongs are being procured that it has been tested and conforms to NSF Standard No. C-2.

4. PACKAGING

4.1 Commercial packaging and packing. The tongs shall be packaged, and packed, and unitized in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

4.2 Marking. Marking of unit packs, shipping containers, and unit loads shall be in accordance with FED-STD-123 or MIL-STD-129, as applicable.

5. NOTES

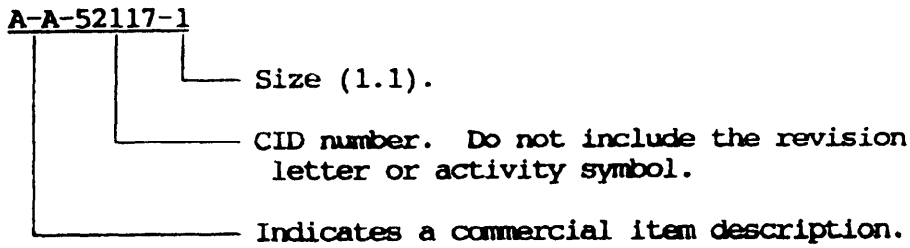
5.1 Intended use. The food serving tongs covered by this commercial item description are intended to provide sanitary food handling.

5.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
b. Size required.

5.3 CID-based part identification number. The following part identification numbering procedure is for Government purposes and does not constitute a requirement for the contractor:

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5.4 Supersession data. The food service tong previously covered by Military Specification MIL-T-40097 is available from this Commercial Item Description.

5.5 Sources of documents.

5.5.1 Sources of non-Government association documents.

NSF Criteria C-2 is available from:

National Sanitation Foundation (NSF)
3475 Plymouth Road
P.O. Box 1468
Ann Arbor, MI 48106

ASTM D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging is available from:

The American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM)
1916 Race Street
Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187

5.5.2 Sources of Governmental documents. Copies of military and federal documents are available from:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

5.6 Government unique requirements. Whenever "Government unique" requirement is included in the title of a paragraph under "Salient Characteristics", it is meant that the requirement is something that is not normally offered to the commercial marketplace by the manufacturer.

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 84

Review Activities

Army - MD, TS
Air Force - 84, 50
DLA - GS

User Activity

Navy - CG, MC

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

Project 7330-0650

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